

Direct unpin of black

By C.G.S.Narayanan

In the realm of problem chess many a theme has been named after its inventor and Gamage is one such theme involving unpin of black. Black closes the line of his pinned piece allowing white to unpin directly on the mating move (by white pinning piece). The first diagram below is a widely known pioneer on this theme.

F.Gamage

I pr, Tidskrift for schack 1911



Mate in two moves

Key 1.Rh4! waiting 1...d6 2.Qh8
1...d5 2.Qh3

In Gamage White on his first move cuts the line of a black pinned piece so that it can be directly unpinned on mating move of the pinning white piece, either in threat or in variation. Bicolour Gamage in thematic tries 1.Bd2? Nb3 2.Qb1# and 1.Be3? c3! 2.Qb5 # Note that in the second try 1...Ne2 2.Qb1# is a normal Gamage.

The other interesting variation is 1...Nd2 2.Bg7 with changed mate from the set. Mike Prcic, American composer wrote in his book on Gamage "We know that this problem In the set position Nd2 is met by 2.Bxd2. White does not have a threatening move and so moves **1.Rh4** and waits! The two thematic variations are 1...d6 2.Qh8 and 1..d5 2.Qh3. In both cases black queen is

unpinned on the mating move but interfered with by his own pawn

F.Gamage

Brisbane Courier 1915



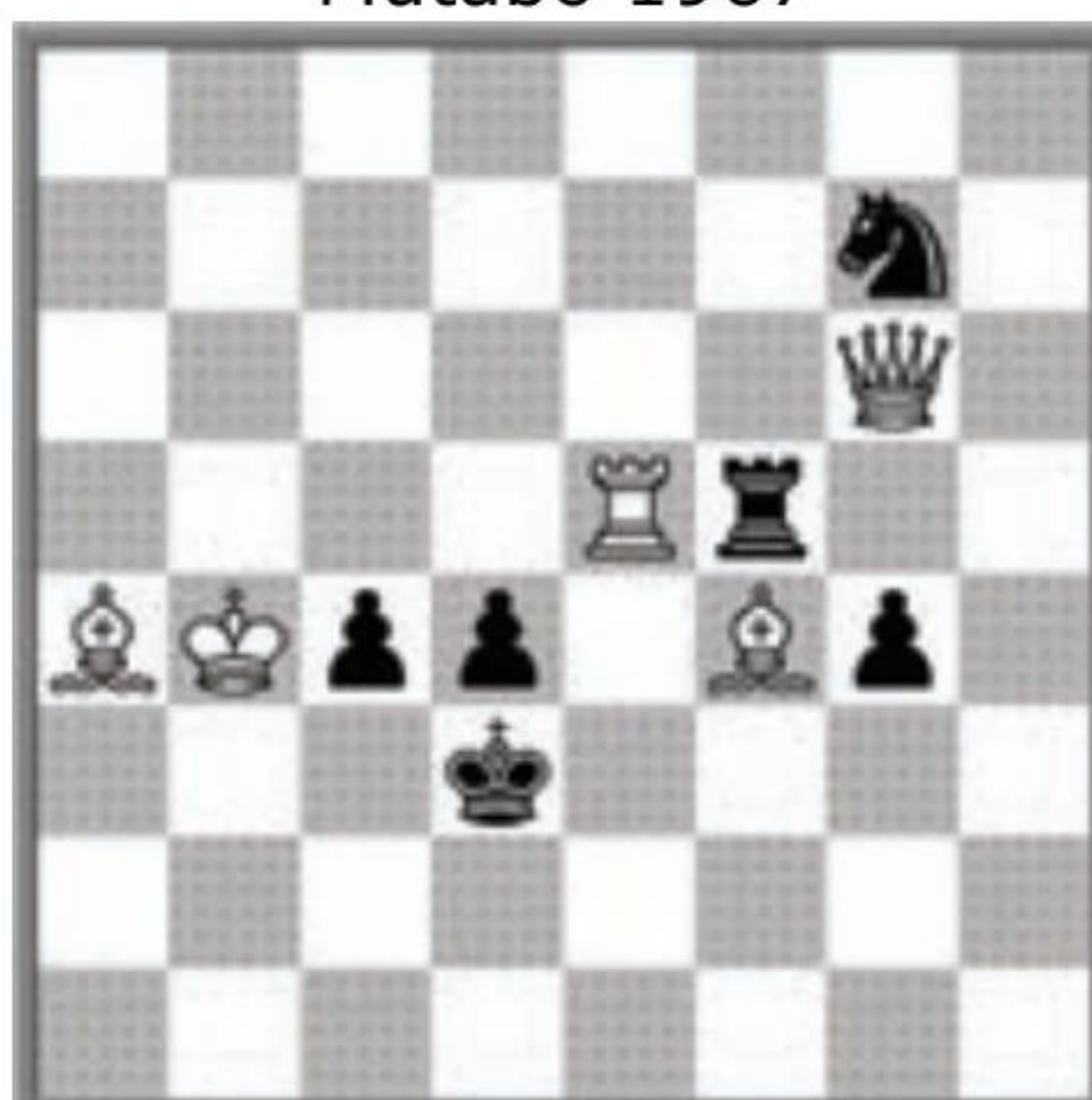
Mate in two moves

After the **key 1.Rc1!** threat 2.Rc4 there are three Gamage unpins 1...Bc3 2.Qb1; 1...Nd6 2.Qxe7 and 1...e6 (cutting off the guard for f5) 2.Qh7. 1...Bb6 2.Qxc6

The problem below for solving is a complete block where two such variations unfold after when thematic tries occur showing bicolour Gamage

Herbert Ahues

Mutabo 1967



Mate in two moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Sacrifice variants'; Set 1...Rf2 2.Rxg3+ Kh5 3.Qe8; 1...Bf2 2.Rf4+ Kh5 3.Qe8; Key **1.Qc4!** waiting 1...Rf2 2.Rf4+ RxR 3.Bf3; 1..Bf2 2.Rxg3+ BxR 3.Bf3. Reciprocal continuation after Grimshaw interference.

Readers may send in their queries to cgsnarayanan@hotmail.com